Legal Conveyancing Performance Analysis Report

Measuring time from Memorandum of Sale to Exchange of Contract, ranked by firm and segmented by tenure and chain position.

PREPARED FOR

Ellison & Grey: Cambridge

Sales progression board

REPORTING PERIOD	EXCHANGES	ISSUED
Apr 2026 to Oct 2026	58	Oct 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The headline: which firms get to exchange fastest

Based on all 58 completed exchanges recorded on this board across the reporting period.

AVG TIME TO EXCHANGE

82 days

~11.7 weeks · median 78 · range 37 to 168 days

FASTEST REGULAR FIRM

56 days

Marsh & Ely Conveyancing · 5 sales · ~3.7 wks under average

THE OPPORTUNITY

~4 weeks / sale

Potential saving by steering toward the consistently faster firms vs. the board average

- **Five firms carry most of the work.** Fenwick Hale, Chesterton Reed, Granta Property Law, Marsh & Ely and Orwell Bright handled 39 of the 55 sales with a firm recorded. These are the regulars worth managing closely.
- **Firm choice matters more than the property.** The fastest regular firm averages 56 days and the slowest 132, a gap of about 11 weeks. That is a bigger swing than tenure or chain, where the four groups range from 73 to 86 days.
- **Consistency matters as much as speed.** Chesterton Reed's slowest file took 97 days, while Fenwick Hale's files ran from 44 to 129 days. Fenwick Hale's typical case (median 77 days) is quicker than its average (80), so a few slow files pull it up. A reliable firm is worth as much as a fast one.
- **The spread analysis:** the quickest exchange took 37 days and the slowest 168, a gap of over four months on the same board.

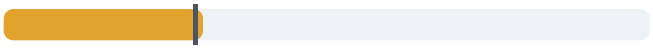
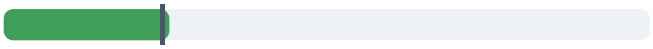
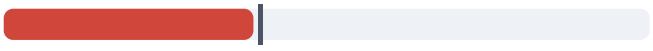
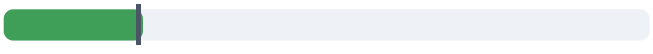
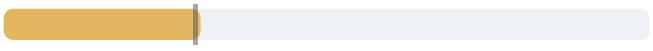
Bars are coloured against the board average of **82 days**: faster | around average | slower. Full league table overleaf.

FIRM LEAGUE TABLE · ELLISON & GREY: CAMBRIDGE

Vendor solicitors ranked by time to exchange

Firms with three or more sales shown individually; one and two sale firms combined. Ranked badge = the five most used firms. Bar = average days; the vertical mark is the median (typical case); the range runs from fastest to slowest.

Faster than average · Around average · Slower than average · = median

FIRM	SALES	DAYS TO EXCHANGE (0 TO 260)	AVG	RANGE
1 Fenwick Hale LLP	14		80 77 med	44–129
2 Chesterton Reed Solicitors	9		66 64 med	41–97
3 Granta Property Law	7		100 103 med	71–141
4 Marsh & Ely Conveyancing	5		56 54 med	42–74
5 Orwell Bright Solicitors	4		132 134 med	101–162
Other firms · 10 firms, one or two sales each	16		79 77 med	37–168

Board average **82 days**. Firms below the average are your faster movers. The combined "other firms" row (16 sales across 10 firms) averages 79 days. Three further exchanges had no usable firm recorded and are excluded from firm figures (see method, final page).

LIKE FOR LIKE · ELLISON & GREY: CAMBRIDGE

The four groups, creating a fair basis for comparison

A leasehold sale in a chain typically takes longer than a chain free freehold. Splitting the data these four ways lets you compare firms on genuinely like for like work.

Freehold / Chain free

79 days · ~11.3 wks

24 exchanges · median 75 · range 37 to 138

Freehold / In a chain

86 days · ~12.3 wks

26 exchanges · median 81 · range 44 to 168

Leasehold / Chain free

73 days · ~10.4 wks

5 exchanges · median 71 · range 52 to 100

Leasehold / In a chain

86 days · ~12.3 wks

3 exchanges · median 71 · range 52 to 135

What stands out: on this board the two freehold groups sit 7 days apart, while the regular firms are 76 days apart. The firm handling the file is a bigger lever on timescale than the tenure or the chain. Leasehold figures rest on only 8 sales, so treat them as indicative.

TOP FIVE FIRMS × THE FOUR GROUPS

Who performs best on comparable work

Average days to exchange. Blank = no sales in that group yet. Cells based on one or two sales are indicative only.

	FREEHOLD CHAIN FREE	FREEHOLD IN A CHAIN	LEASEHOLD CHAIN FREE	LEASEHOLD IN A CHAIN
Fenwick Hale LLP	**75** n=6	**84** n=7	**80** n=1	–
Chesterton Reed Solicitors	**60** n=4	**72** n=4	**64** n=1	–
Granta Property Law	**93** n=3	**105** n=4	–	–
Marsh & Ely Conveyancing	**54** n=3	**59** n=2	–	–
Orwell Bright Solicitors	–	**131** n=3	–	**135** n=1

THE FULL JOURNEY

From Memorandum of Sale to completion

Up to exchange is where the solicitor has most influence; completion adds the post exchange run in. For completeness, both are measured from the day the Memorandum of Sale was received.

AVG MOS TO EXCHANGE

82 days

~11.7 weeks · median 78 days

AVG MOS TO COMPLETION

87 days

~12.4 weeks · a further ~5 days after exchange

WHAT SITS BEHIND THE FIGURES

Coverage & reliability

Exchanges analysed

58 files

Every completed exchange on this board in the reporting period

Vendor solicitor identifiable

95%

55 of 58 files carried a usable firm name; the other 3 are excluded from firm figures

Reading the numbers: figures for any firm or group with fewer than about five sales are indicative rather than conclusive. The smaller the sample, the more one unusual case moves the average. Where a firm's typical case (median) sits well below its average, a single slow file is the cause, not the norm.

METHOD & DATA QUALITY

How the numbers were built

ITEM	APPROACH
Core metric	Calendar days between **Memorandum of Sale received** and **Exchange of contract**. Completion view uses MoS to Completion. Only completed exchanges are included. Files marked **Part Progressed** (taken on part way through the sale) are excluded, as their timescale does not reflect the whole conveyancing process.
Solicitor	The **vendor's** solicitor, that is the firm acting for the seller. Buyer side figures can be produced on request.
Chain grouping	Derived from the buyer type recorded on each file. **Chain free** = Nothing to Sell, First time Buyer, Buy to Let; **In a chain** = Standard, End of Chain. Two files had no buyer type recorded and are counted as in a chain.
Firm grouping	Free typed solicitor entries were grouped under one firm name where they refer to the same firm (spellings listed below).
Coverage	Firm identifiable on **55 of 58** exchanges on this board. The 3 unrecorded files are excluded from firm figures but still count in the overall and group averages.
On hold time	Kept as true elapsed days. Time spent on hold is not deducted, so each figure is the actual number of days between the two dates.
Source	Momentum's live case records, as at 22 October 2026.

FIRM NAME MERGES

Each firm below was assembled from these recorded spellings.

FIRM	SPELLINGS RECORDED
Fenwick Hale LLP	Fenwick Hale LLP · Fenwick Hale · Fenwick Hale Solicitors
Chesterton Reed Solicitors	Chesterton Reed Solicitors · Chesterton Reed
Granta Property Law	Granta Property Law · Granta Law · Granta Property Law Ltd
Marsh & Ely Conveyancing	Marsh & Ely Conveyancing · Marsh and Ely